AP Computer Science

Scripps Ranch High School

Teacher Information
Name: Mr. Sacco
Email: isacco@sandi.net
Room: 418

Course Description

Advance Placement Computer Science is a college level course involving programming using the Java language. The major emphasis of this course will be the programming methodology, algorithms, and data structures that are a part of the AP subset. Students are expected, but not required, to take the AP test in May, which they may receive college credit for if they receive a passing score.

Weighted Grade Categories:	**Marks:**
60% Tests and Quizzes	A : 90 - 100
40% Labs, Classwork, and Homework	B : 80 - 89
	C : 70 - 79
	D : 60 - 69
	F : 59 and below

Tutoring and Extra Lab Time:

For students that would like to catch up on assignments or to receive some extra help from Mr. Sacco, lab hours are available:
Before School: Mr. Sacco gets to school at 7:00 am most days.
During Lunch: Mr. Sacco is almost always in his room during lunch. This is when most students get tutoring.
After School: Mr. Sacco can usually give an extra 30 minutes after school, but students should confirm his availability before showing up.

Course Website/Materials:

This class is nearly 100% run through a course site on **Schoology.com**. This is where all notes and resources will be posted and students will submit all programming assignment and homework. While Schoology does have a grades section, it may be ignored. All grades will be entered in PowerSchool when completed.

Textbook: Java Concepts with Java Essentials by Cay Horstmann

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Free Public Education:

The Constitution of the State of California requires that we provide a public education to you free of charge. Your right to a free education is for all school/educational activities, whether curricular or extracurricular, & whether you get a grade for the activity or class. Subject to certain exceptions, your right to a free public education means that we cannot require you or your family to purchase materials, supplies, equipment or uniforms for any school activity, nor can we require you or your family to pay security deposits for access, participation, materials, or equipment. You may be required to attend a fundraising event; however, if you are unable to raise funds for the event, you will not be prevented from participating in an educational activity.
For more information visit www.sandi.net/staff/studentfees.

Important Items:

Two Day Rule (Late Work):

For each programming assignment students will be given some time in class to work and there will be a date on the assignment that will be considered the due date. This date is the moment that class time will no longer be dedicated to that specific assignment and the class will move on to a new topic. Students who do not submit by the due date will have two **school days** to finish the programs **outside of class** and submit the assignment for no penalty. At the **end of school** on that second day all assignments are given their final grade with no chance for makeups.

- This is to allow the student time to work from **home** or come to **tutoring** and catch up with the rest of the class. They will **not** be allowed to work on them during class time. After two school days, the assignment is graded and no more late work is accepted.
- This time is **not** extended if Mr. Sacco's class doesn't meet for one of the days due to block scheduling. This time is for working **outside** of class time to catch up. When the class meets is irrelevant.
- This extra time is for those that need it and may be revoked if the student is not putting effort in during class. For example, if a student is found doing homework for another class or playing games online during time that's meant for working on an assignment, that student waives their right to have extra time on assignments.
- If a student misses class for one day, they do not get an extra day to work on assignments. They simply use up one of the extra days. Students that miss more than one day must talk to Mr. Sacco about due dates.
- This rule only applies to programming classwork. In general, there will only be about a few small homework assignments that don't involve full programs. Students must submit these on or before the due date.
- Each night, a student's homework is to make sure that they are keeping pace with the class and coming to get help when needed.

Plagiarism:

Learning to program is a process that requires lots of practice, and struggling through errors is an important step in that process. Students who plagiarize code are refusing to do the work required to be successful. Mr. Sacco spends lots of time creating assignments that will help students be successful in the class and he provides lots of opportunity for tutoring and extra help. When a student plagiarizes they are completely disregarding all the time and effort Mr. Sacco has put in to help them and will not gain the skills that they are supposed to develop. For this reason, Mr. Sacco has absolutely zero tolerance for plagiarism. When plagiarism is discovered, **both** students involved will receive zeros for that assignment. Once Mr. Sacco sees that students are turning in the same work, he will go to all the previously submit assignments and update any grades with similar plagiarism to zero. This can drop a student's grade dramatically.

Plagiarism occurs the moment that a student is given any sort of possession of another student's code, regardless of intent. Students are allowed to look at each other's code to and talk about the strategy used, but when code is simply given to another student they frequently end up copying the process and claiming they "worked together". This earns all students a zero; do not ever give access to your code to anyone.

The following are a few examples of the ways that students have earned automatic zeros:

- Two or more students emailing code to each other "for reference"
- One student takes a picture of the other student's program "for reference"
- One student shares their password with another student
- Two students turn in the same code and claim they "worked together at home"
- A student who has access to all the work from a student who had Sacco in a previous year.
- A student leaves completed code open on screen while another student looks at it and copies.
- A student copies another student's code, but make small, insignificant changes so that their code will look 'different'

Please sign and return this syllabus to Mr. Sacco for credit. A digital version of this syllabus is available on the course website at schoology.com

I have read and understand the syllabus for Mr. Sacco's AP Computer Science class.

Student Name (Print): _____

Student Signature: _____ Date: _____

Parent Name (Print): _____

Parent Signature: _____ Date: _____